Rupa. Earlier, 1 Sikh LI's headlong retreat from Bomdila had only ended when the troops had reached Chaku. These troops were now expected to take up a defensive position in and around Chaku.

1 Madras had all but fallen off everybody's radar, and on 19 November, no one had any idea of the whereabouts of the battalion. The Chinese, in the meantime, had entered Bomdila and found it to be completely deserted. Realizing that the Indians were retreating, the Chinese commander decided to further exploit the situation. His already extended force was now ordered to make a run downhill for Tenga. The rapid movement of Chinese troops was to be a masterstroke. Before either 3 JAK Rif or 6/8 GR could begin to take up positions, the Chinese were onto them, leading to complete panic among the Indian troops who were now strung out between Tenga-Rupa and Chaku. Those who were the last to leave Bomdila were caught on the road near Tenga and gunned down. The two officers from 67 Brigade, Major Shashi Dang and Captain Lakhan Pal were among those who were cut off. While the former was killed, Lakhan Pal escaped by playing dead, lying amidst the bodies of his fallen comrades. So intent were the Chinese on getting a move on, they did not bother to search for survivors among the dead.

The brunt of the Chinese attack around Tenga was felt by 3 JAK Rif. After shooting up the bunched up troops on the road, part of the Chinese force turned its attention to 3 JAK Rif. By 9 a.m., the Chinese had engaged the battalion with 2-inch and 3-inch mortars and LMG fire. The JAK Rif mortar platoons returned fire, but it was at best a perfunctory gesture in the absence of any defences whatsoever. As the casualties mounted, the battalion broke up into small parties and scattered in a desperate attempt to save themselves. By midday, 3 JAK Rif had ceased to exist as a fighting force. While some men managed to fall back towards Chaku, the bulk of the survivors over the next few days had to make their way through the dense jungles directly to Tezpur. Gurdial Singh was taken prisoner, while the battalion lost another ninety-seven men who were either killed, captured or went missing.

Leaving their mortar sections to deal with 3 JAK Rif, the Chinese went after 6/8 GR who were caught in the Rupa gap as they were scrambling back in vehicles for the defence of Rupa. The soft-top vehicles afforded little protection for the Gorkhas, who suffered serious casualties. However, the battalion managed to deploy on the northern track that they held for a